

KINGDOM LIFE MINISTRY

The Seven Feasts of YHWH

*His appointed times, the shadow they cast,
and the fulfillment in Yahshua*

*A Kingdom Life teaching handout on Leviticus 23
Scripture from the World English Bible, divine name rendered YHWH, Elohim, and Adonai*

THE HEART OF IT

Seven lamps stand on one lampstand, hammered out of a single piece of gold. Seven feasts stand on one calendar, hammered out of a single plan of redemption. They are not Jewish holidays and they are not ours to move. Leviticus 23 calls them *the set feasts of YHWH*, his appointed times, and Scripture shows him filling them in with real events on the exact days. The first four are already fulfilled. The last three are still ahead. If you want to know what YHWH is doing on the earth, he wrote the schedule down and told his people to keep it.

Restoring YHWH's design for marriage, family, forgiveness, and deliverance.

SECTION ONE

They Are His Feasts, Not Ours

Before Leviticus 23 lists a single date, it settles a question of ownership. Verse 2 names them twice and verse 4 names them again, and one of those is YHWH himself saying *these are my appointed times*. They do not belong to a nation, a denomination, or a culture. They belong to YHWH, and he is the one who assigns the calendar.

YHWH spoke to Moses, saying, “Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them, ‘The set feasts of YHWH, which you shall proclaim to be holy convocations, even these are my set feasts.’”

LEVITICUS 23:1-2

These are the set feasts of YHWH, even holy convocations, which you shall proclaim in their appointed season.

LEVITICUS 23:4

The Hebrew word behind *set feast* is **moed**, an appointed time, a fixed meeting. A moed is not a party. It is an appointment that one party has already put on the calendar and the other party is expected to keep.

The word behind *holy convocation* is **miqra qodesh**. Miqra comes from the root **qara**, to call, to proclaim, to summon, to read. It means a sacred assembly, a called gathering, a day his people are summoned to. It is worth saying plainly that it does not mean *rehearsal*. That is a popular teaching and it is not what the word carries. The prophetic weight of these days is real, but it comes from the events Scripture records landing on them, not from a meaning pressed into a Hebrew noun.

A NOTE ON THE WORD FEAST

Scripture itself uses two different words. **Moed** is the appointed time, and that is the word covering everything in Leviticus 23. **Chag** is the pilgrimage festival, and only three of these carry it: Unleavened Bread, Weeks, and Booths (Exodus 23:14-17; Deuteronomy 16:16). Calling all of them feasts is common English shorthand, and counting them as seven is a grouping we make rather than a number the chapter gives, since Leviticus 23 opens with the weekly Sabbath and closes with the eighth day assembly. Nothing in this study depends on the number. It depends on the chapter.

The appointments were built into creation itself before there was an Israel to keep them.

Elohim said, “Let there be lights in the expanse of the sky to divide the day from the night; and let them be for signs to mark seasons, days, and years.”

GENESIS 1:14

He appointed the moon for seasons. The sun knows when to set.

PSALM 104:19

The word rendered *seasons* in both places is that same word, moed. The sun and moon were hung in the sky as the clock for his appointed times. That is why the feasts move on our modern calendar and never

move on his.

NOTE THE WORDING

Four separate times in this one chapter these instructions are sealed with the phrase *a statute forever throughout your generations* (Leviticus 23:14, 21, 31, 41). Forever is a long time. Nothing in Scripture ever cancels these appointments, and the last book of the Bible still has the nations keeping one of them (Zechariah 14:16).

SECTION TWO

The Lampstand and the Pattern

The picture of seven feasts standing on a menorah is a good one, because the menorah itself teaches the same lesson. It was not assembled from seven separate parts bolted together. It was beaten out of one solid piece of gold.

You shall make a lampstand of pure gold. The lampstand shall be made of hammered work. Its base, its shaft, its cups, its buds, and its flowers shall be of one piece with it. There shall be six branches going out of its sides.

EXODUS 25:31-32

One piece, one hammering, seven lights. The feasts are the same. They are not seven unrelated holidays. They are one plan, struck out of one mind, and each lamp throws light on the next one. Zechariah sees the same lampstand and is told plainly that it is not accomplished by might or power but by his Spirit (Zechariah 4:2, 6), and John sees Yahshua standing in the middle of seven lampstands in Revelation 1:12-13, 20.

A few things worth seeing before we walk the seven:

- **1. The weekly Sabbath is listed first.** Before Passover is mentioned, Leviticus 23:3 puts the seventh day Sabbath at the head of the list of appointed times. The yearly appointments are built on top of a weekly one that YHWH set at creation.
- **2. Three of them require a journey.** Unleavened Bread, Weeks, and Tabernacles are the three times a year all the males were to appear before YHWH (Exodus 23:14-17; Deuteronomy 16:16). Those three anchor the spring, the summer, and the fall.
- **3. They fall in two clusters with a hinge in the middle.** Four in the spring, in the first and third months. Three in the fall, all in the seventh month. Pentecost sits in the center of the lampstand, on the main shaft, joining the two.
- **4. The spring feasts are already fulfilled, to the day.** Yahshua died at Passover, lay in the grave through Unleavened Bread, rose on Firstfruits, and poured out his Spirit on Pentecost. Not one of those was close to the date. Each was exact. That precision is the reason to take the three fall feasts seriously.

1. Passover

First month, 14th day, at twilight. Leviticus 23:5. The lamb slain and the blood applied.

2. Unleavened Bread	First month, 15th through 21st, seven days. Leviticus 23:6-8. Sin removed and the body in the tomb.
3. Firstfruits	The morrow after the Sabbath, Leviticus 23:11. The first sheaf lifted up, the resurrection.
4. Pentecost	Fifty days later, counted. Leviticus 23:15-22. Instructions at Sinai, the Spirit in Acts 2, written on hearts.
5. Trumpets	Seventh month, first day. Leviticus 23:23-25. A memorial of blowing, the only moed on the head of a month.
6. Atonement	Seventh month, tenth day. Leviticus 23:26-32. Affliction, repentance, blood behind the veil.
7. Tabernacles	Seventh month, 15th through 21st, plus the eighth day. Leviticus 23:33-43. Elohim dwelling with his people.

FEAST ONE

Passover

In the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month in the evening, is YHWH's Passover.

LEVITICUS 23:5

The instruction. Exodus 12 gives the whole picture. A lamb is selected on the tenth day, kept until the fourteenth, then killed at twilight by the whole assembly. The blood goes on the two doorposts and the lintel. The household eats the lamb inside the house, and death passes over every door where the blood is applied.

Your lamb shall be without defect, a male a year old. ... The blood shall be to you for a token on the houses where you are. When I see the blood, I will pass over you, and no plague will be on you to destroy you.

EXODUS 12:5, 13

What it pictures. Substitution. The lamb dies in the place of the firstborn. Notice that the blood on the doorpost saved nobody who left it in the basin. Applied blood, not available blood, is what death passes over.

The fulfillment. Yahshua is the lamb. John the Immerser names him as such the first time he lays eyes on him.

"Behold, the Lamb of Elohim, who takes away the sin of the world!"

JOHN 1:29

Purge out the old yeast, that you may be a new lump ... For indeed Messiah, our Passover, has been sacrificed in our place.

1 CORINTHIANS 5:7

He was inspected publicly for days in Jerusalem and no fault was found (Luke 23:4, 14-15; John 18:38). The lamb was to have no bone broken (Exodus 12:46; Numbers 9:12; Psalm 34:20), and the soldiers who came to break his legs found him already dead and did not break one (John 19:33, 36). He was without blemish in the only way that counts (Isaiah 53:7, 9; 2 Corinthians 5:21; Hebrews 4:15; 1 Peter 1:18-19).

ON THE CHRONOLOGY

Yahshua shared a final meal with his disciples on the night he was betrayed (1 Corinthians 11:23). Matthew, Mark, and Luke call it the Passover (Matthew 26:17-20; Mark 14:12-17; Luke 22:7-15). John sets that evening before the feast of the Passover (John 13:1) and records that the next morning the leaders who handed him over still had not eaten the Passover (John 18:28). He was crucified on the Preparation Day, and John calls the Sabbath that followed a special one (John 19:14, 31), which fits a week carrying two Sabbaths. This study reads the meal as coming before the Passover the leaders kept. It does not claim he died at the same hour the lambs were slaughtered. Scripture does not say that.

THE DOORPOST IS STILL THE QUESTION

Redemption has never been automatic. Egypt was full of lambs that night, but only the houses with blood on the door were passed over. The question was never whether the lamb was good enough. It was whether the blood had been applied to that particular door. Hebrews 9:22 puts it plainly: apart from shedding of blood there is no remission.

FEAST TWO**Unleavened Bread**

On the fifteenth day of the same month is the feast of unleavened bread to YHWH. Seven days you shall eat unleavened bread. In the first day you shall have a holy convocation. You shall do no regular work.

LEVITICUS 23:6-7

The instruction. Seven days of bread with no leaven in it, and leaven put out of the houses entirely (Exodus 12:15-20; Exodus 13:6-7). Israel left Egypt in such a hurry the dough had no time to rise (Exodus 12:39). Deliverance was immediate, and there was no time to bring the old life along.

What it pictures. Leaven is the picture of sin working quietly through a whole life, and of corrupt teaching working through a whole assembly.

Your boasting is not good. Don't you know that a little yeast leavens the whole lump? ... Therefore let's keep the feast, not with old yeast, neither with the yeast of malice and wickedness, but with the unleavened bread of sincerity and truth.

1 CORINTHIANS 5:6-8

Paul writes that to a mixed assembly, long after the resurrection, and tells them to keep the feast. Yahshua used the same picture for doctrine, warning about the leaven of the Pharisees and Sadducees, which he explained was their teaching (Matthew 16:6-12).

The fulfillment. This is the feast of the burial. The sinless one, the bread without corruption in it, was laid in the tomb while the feast was being kept.

For you will not leave my soul in Sheol, neither will you allow your holy one to see corruption.

PSALM 16:10

Peter and Paul both preach that verse as the resurrection proof: his flesh did not decay (Acts 2:27, 31; Acts 13:35-37). He called himself the bread of life that came down out of heaven, and said the bread he would give is his flesh (John 6:35, 48-51). He was born in Bethlehem, which means house of bread (Micah 5:2), and he was laid in a feeding trough.

Walking it out. Cleaning the leaven out of the house for a week is a physical picture of something spiritual. You go through cabinets you have not opened in a year and find things you forgot were there. That is the point.

FEAST THREE

Firstfruits

When you have come into the land which I give to you, and shall reap its harvest, then you shall bring the sheaf of the first fruits of your harvest to the priest. He shall wave the sheaf before YHWH, to be accepted for you. On the next day after the Sabbath the priest shall wave it.

LEVITICUS 23:10-11

The instruction. The first sheaf of the barley harvest is cut and lifted up before YHWH, and nothing of the new harvest may be eaten until that sheaf has been brought (Leviticus 23:14). The first one presented guarantees that the whole field is coming.

Read the wording carefully. Leviticus 23:11 does not say the day after Unleavened Bread begins. It says *the morrow after the Sabbath*, and the count to Pentecost is measured from that same morrow through seven complete Sabbaths (Leviticus 23:15-16). This handout takes the Sabbath there as the weekly Sabbath, which is what the text says, rather than reading a later calendar system back into it.

The fulfillment. Paul does not hint at this. He names it.

But now Messiah has been raised from the dead. He became the first fruits of those who are asleep. ... But each in his own order: Messiah the first fruits, then those who are Messiah's at his coming.

1 CORINTHIANS 15:20, 23

The women came to the tomb early on the first day of the week and found it already empty (Matthew 28:1-6; Mark 16:2-6; John 20:1). He is called the firstborn from the dead and the firstborn among many brothers (Colossians 1:18; Romans 8:29), and we are called a kind of firstfruits of his creatures (James 1:18). The wave sheaf had to be presented before anyone could eat, and on that morning Yahshua told Miriam not to hold him because he had not yet ascended to the Father (John 20:17). The sheaf was on its way to be presented.

ON THE TIMING

He said the only sign given would be Jonah: three days and three nights in the heart of the earth (Matthew 12:40). A Wednesday evening burial, with the high Sabbath of Unleavened Bread following (John 19:31 calls it a great day, not the weekly one), gives exactly three days and three nights and still has the tomb empty before the women arrive on the first day. That week had two Sabbaths in it, which is why the accounts fit together rather than contradicting.

There was even a first harvest that came up with him: tombs were opened, and after his resurrection many bodies of holy ones who had fallen asleep were raised and appeared to many in the city (Matthew 27:52-53). A sheaf, not a single stalk.

FEAST FOUR

Pentecost, the Feast of Weeks

You shall count from the next day after the Sabbath ... seven Sabbaths shall be completed. Next day after the seventh Sabbath you shall count fifty days, and you shall offer a new meal offering to YHWH. ... They shall be baked with yeast, for first fruits to YHWH.

LEVITICUS 23:15-17

The instruction. This is the only feast you have to count to. Fifty days from the wave sheaf, then two loaves of wheat bread are waved before YHWH, and these two loaves are deliberately baked *with* leaven, the only such offering in the chapter. The same passage ends by telling the farmer not to reap the corners of his field, but to leave the gleanings for the poor and the foreigner (Leviticus 23:22; compare Deuteronomy 16:9-12).

What it pictures at Sinai. Israel came to Sinai in the third month (Exodus 19:1). The mountain burned with fire, there was a voice like a trumpet, and YHWH spoke his instructions and wrote them with his own finger on stone (Exodus 19:16-20; 20:1-17; 31:18). Fire, a loud voice, and his words given to a gathered people. Hold that picture.

The fulfillment in Acts 2. At Pentecost, fire again, a sound from heaven again, and his instructions delivered again, this time not onto stone.

Now when the day of Pentecost had come, they were all with one accord in one place. Suddenly there came from the sky a sound like the rushing of a mighty wind ... Tongues like fire appeared and were distributed to them, and one sat on each of them.

ACTS 2:1-3

I will put my law in their inward parts, and I will write it in their heart. I will be their Elohim, and they shall be my people.

JEREMIAH 31:33

That is the whole point of the day. At Sinai his instructions went onto tablets of stone. In Acts 2 the same instructions went into hearts of flesh, exactly as Ezekiel 36:26-27 promised: a new heart, a new spirit, and his Spirit causing his people to walk in his statutes. Paul makes the comparison directly, saying we are a letter written not with ink but with the Spirit of the living Elohim, not on stone but on tablets that are hearts (2 Corinthians 3:3). Peter stood up and quoted Joel 2:28-29 to explain what everyone was watching (Acts 2:16-21).

There is a sober detail in the comparison. At Sinai, when the people made the calf, about three thousand men fell (Exodus 32:28). In Acts 2, about three thousand souls were added (Acts 2:41). The same number, running the other direction.

WHY TWO LOAVES, AND WHY WITH LEAVEN

Every other offering in Leviticus 23 is unleavened. These two are not, and there are two of them. Leaven still pictures what is in us, so these loaves read as a picture of a people accepted and waved before him while they are still being dealt with. Two of them, waved together as one offering, lines up with the two sticks of Ezekiel 37:15-22 becoming one in his hand, and with the two being made into one new man in Ephesians 2:11-16. Judah and Ephraim, the near and the far off, lifted up together. Leviticus does not spell that out, so take it as a pattern worth weighing rather than a commandment.

The gleaning instruction attached to this feast is not decoration either. It is the instruction that put Ruth, a Moabite, in the field of Boaz between the barley and the wheat harvests (Ruth 1:22; 2:2-3, 23). A foreigner gleaning at Pentecost, redeemed by a kinsman, and written into the line of the Messiah.

FEAST FIVE

Trumpets, Yom Teruah

In the seventh month, on the first day of the month, shall be a solemn rest to you, a memorial of blowing of trumpets, a holy convocation. You shall do no regular work.

LEVITICUS 23:24-25

The instruction. A day of blowing, on the first day of the seventh month (Numbers 29:1-6). The trumpets themselves were given for gathering the assembly, for setting out on a journey, for sounding an alarm in war, and for the appointed times and new moons (Numbers 10:1-10; Psalm 81:3).

What makes this one different. It is the only appointed time in Leviticus 23 that falls on the head of a month. Every other one is counted from a date already fixed inside a month that is already running. This one begins when the month begins.

SAY ONLY WHAT TORAH SAYS

It is common to teach that this day waits on a crescent sighting. This handout does not, because Torah gives no such commandment. There is no verse instructing anyone to go out, look for a first visible crescent, and declare the month on the testimony of witnesses. What Scripture does say is that the moon was appointed for the moedim (Psalm 104:19) and that trumpets sounded at the beginnings of the months (Numbers 10:10; Numbers 28:11). The month is tied to the moon. The mechanism is not spelled out, and 1 Samuel 20:5, 18 shows David and Jonathan knowing the day in advance. Where Scripture stops speaking, we stop calling our interpretation a commandment.

The fulfillment ahead. The main passages about his return have a trumpet in them.

For Adonai himself will descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel and with Elohim's trumpet. The dead in Messiah will rise first, then we who are alive, who are left, will be caught up together with them in the clouds.

1 THESSALONIANS 4:16-17

We will all be changed, in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet. For the trumpet will sound and the dead will be raised incorruptible, and we will be changed.

1 CORINTHIANS 15:51-52

Read Matthew 24 carefully on the order. Yahshua says that immediately *after* the tribulation of those days the sun is darkened, the sign of the Son of Man appears, and then he sends out his messengers with a great sound of a trumpet to gather his chosen ones from the four winds (Matthew 24:29-31). That is the same event Paul describes: the dead raised, the living changed into bodies that do not corrupt, all at the trumpet. It is a resurrection at the last trumpet, not a quiet removal beforehand. The seventh messenger sounds and the announcement is made that the kingdom of the world has become the Kingdom of our Adonai and of his Messiah (Revelation 11:15). That case is built on explicit text and needs nothing else propping it up.

The prophets sound the same alarm on the same day: blow the trumpet in Zion, sound an alarm in my holy mountain (Joel 2:1), and the great trumpet that brings home the ones who were ready to perish (Isaiah 27:13; compare Zephaniah 1:14-16).

WATCH, BECAUSE YOU ARE NOT TOLD TO CALCULATE

Yahshua said no one knows the day or the hour of his return (Matthew 24:36). Scripture does not tie that statement to this feast in so many words, so treat the connection as a pattern worth weighing rather than a proof. What is not optional is the instruction attached to it. It is not calculation. It is readiness (Matthew 24:42-44; Matthew 25:1-13). Ten virgins all had lamps. Five had oil.

FEAST SIX

Atonement, Yom Kippur

However on the tenth day of this seventh month is the day of atonement. It shall be a holy convocation to you. You shall afflict yourselves ... You shall do no kind of work ... It shall be a Sabbath of solemn rest to you, and you shall afflict your souls. In the ninth day of the month at evening, from evening to evening, you shall keep your Sabbath.

LEVITICUS 23:27-28, 32

The instruction. One day a year the high priest went behind the veil with blood. He bathed, put off his glory and put on plain linen, offered first for himself, then took two goats. Lots were cast: one goat for YHWH, whose blood went into the most holy place, and one goat sent away alive, carrying the iniquities of the people to a solitary land (Leviticus 16:3-22).

The fulfillment. The book of Hebrews is essentially a commentary on this day.

But Messiah having come as a high priest of the coming good things ... nor yet through the blood of goats and calves, but through his own blood, entered in once for all into the Holy Place, having obtained eternal redemption.

HEBREWS 9:11-12

He did not enter a copy but heaven itself, to appear before the face of Elohim for us (Hebrews 9:24). He was offered once to bear the sins of many, and will appear a second time, apart from sin, to those who are eagerly waiting (Hebrews 9:28). Where the old priests stood daily offering sacrifices that could never take away sins, he offered one sacrifice forever and sat down (Hebrews 10:11-12). Isaiah saw both goats in one person: wounded for our transgressions, and YHWH laid on him the iniquity of us all (Isaiah 53:5-6).

What is still ahead. Zechariah puts a national day of mourning and recognition at the end.

I will pour on David's house and on the inhabitants of Jerusalem the spirit of grace and of supplication. They will look to me whom they have pierced; and they shall mourn for him.

ZECHARIAH 12:10

And in that day, as they mourn, a fountain is opened for sin and uncleanness (Zechariah 13:1). There is one more thread: the Jubilee trumpet was sounded on the Day of Atonement, and liberty was proclaimed

throughout the land, every man returning to his possession and to his family (Leviticus 25:9-10). Debts cleared, land returned, slaves released, all announced on this day. That is the year Yahshua stood up and read out of Isaiah 61 and said it was fulfilled in their hearing (Luke 4:18-19).

AFFLICT YOUR SOULS

Leviticus commands the affliction and does not define the word in the chapter, so let Scripture define it. *I afflicted my soul with fasting* (Psalm 35:13), and Isaiah 58:3 and 5 put fasting and afflicting the soul side by side before telling you what YHWH is actually after with it (Isaiah 58:6-7). Ezra proclaimed a fast to afflict themselves before their Elohim (Ezra 8:21). So the fasting is Scripture's own application, not a tradition bolted on. This is the one appointed time that is not a celebration. Humble yourself, search out what you have been carrying, and make it right. Pride is what keeps a man from doing that honestly, and unforgiveness is what pride looks like once it has been sitting a while. If forgiveness is the root of deliverance, then this day is the appointed time for it.

FEAST SEVEN

Tabernacles, Sukkot, and the Eighth Day

On the fifteenth day of this seventh month is the feast of booths for seven days to YHWH. ... On the eighth day shall be a holy convocation to you ... It is a solemn assembly.

LEVITICUS 23:34, 36

You shall dwell in booths seven days. All who are native born in Israel shall dwell in booths, that your generations may know that I made the children of Israel to dwell in booths when I brought them out of the land of Egypt.

LEVITICUS 23:42-43

The instruction. Leave your house. Build a temporary shelter out of branches and live in it for a week. Take the fruit of majestic trees, palm branches, leafy boughs, and willows of the brook, and rejoice before YHWH seven days (Leviticus 23:40). Deuteronomy 16:13-15 says it twice: you shall rejoice, and you shall be altogether joyful. Nehemiah 8:14-18 records the whole city doing it again after the exile, with very great gladness.

What it pictures. That YHWH dwells with his people, and that this life is the temporary structure, not the permanent one. A week in a booth teaches what a thousand sermons on contentment cannot.

The Word became flesh and lived among us. We saw his glory, such glory as of the one and only Son of the Father, full of grace and truth.

JOHN 1:14

The Hebrew word for the shelter is **sukkah**, and the command to dwell in them is Leviticus 23:42. When John writes that the Word *lived among us*, the Greek verb is *skenoo*, from *skene*, a tent. He pitched his tent among us. He tabernacled in flesh. And the scene John is given at the end of the book is the feast made permanent.

Behold, Elohim's dwelling is with people; and he will dwell with them, and they will be his people, and Elohim himself will be with them as their Elohim.

REVELATION 21:3

Yahshua taught publicly at this feast, and on the last and greatest day of it he stood and cried out that anyone who is thirsty should come to him and drink, promising rivers of living water, which John explains was the Spirit (John 7:2, 37-39). In the same setting he said he is the light of the world (John 8:12). Water and light, at the feast of dwelling.

The eighth day. Scripture sets the eighth day apart from the seven. It is its own holy convocation, its own solemn assembly, after the booths come down. Seven is the number of the completed cycle. Eight is what comes after the cycle is finished: new creation, new beginning. Leviticus 23 does not tell us what the eighth day pictures, so what follows is offered as an interpretation rather than a commandment. I believe this is where the marriage supper of the Lamb belongs.

Let's rejoice and be exceedingly glad, and let's give the glory to him. For the wedding of the Lamb has come, and his wife has made herself ready. ... Blessed are those who are invited to the wedding supper of the Lamb.

REVELATION 19:7, 9

And as the book draws to a close, John sees a new heaven and a new earth, and the bride coming down adorned for her husband (Revelation 21:1-2). Seven days of dwelling with him, then the eighth day, and everything is made new. Weigh it against the text and hold it loosely where the text is quiet.

THIS ONE IS KEPT AFTER HE RETURNS

Zechariah 14:16-19 says that everyone left of the nations that came against Jerusalem will go up year after year to worship the King, YHWH of Armies, and to keep the feast of booths, with consequences for the families that refuse. That is after his return, in his Kingdom, with the nations included. Anyone who says these appointed times were done away with has to explain why the nations are keeping this one in the age to come.

SECTION TEN

The Shadow and the Body

One passage gets quoted more than any other to argue that these days no longer matter, so it is worth reading slowly.

Let no one therefore judge you in eating or drinking, or with respect to a feast day or a new moon or a Sabbath day, which are a shadow of the things to come; but the body is Messiah's.

COLOSSIANS 2:16-17

Paul does not say the feast days are cancelled. He says do not let anyone judge you with respect to them, and he says they are a shadow of things **to come**, which is future tense for things still ahead. A shadow is proof that something real is standing there casting it. You do not throw out the shadow because you have found the body. You look at the shadow and it tells you the shape of the one it belongs to. The priesthood serves a copy and shadow of heavenly things (Hebrews 8:5), and the instructions hold a shadow of the good things to come (Hebrews 10:1). Whatever else anyone makes of the passage, Paul never writes that YHWH's Sabbath and appointed times have been abolished.

Scripture keeps the appointed times running long after the resurrection and long into the future:

Luke 22:15-16	He says he will not eat the Passover again until it is fulfilled in the Kingdom of Elohim. A future Passover is on his calendar.
Acts 2:1	The disciples are gathered on the day of Pentecost because they were keeping it.
Acts 20:6, 16	Paul sails after the days of unleavened bread and hurries to be in Jerusalem for Pentecost.
1 Cor 5:7-8	Paul tells a mostly non-Jewish assembly in Corinth to keep the feast.
Ezekiel 45:17, 21, 25	Passover and the feast of the seventh month are being kept in the temple Ezekiel is shown.
Zechariah 14:16	The nations go up yearly to keep the feast of booths after his return.
Isaiah 66:23	From one new moon to another and from one Sabbath to another, all flesh comes to worship before him.

The appointed times are his teaching tool. Amos 3:7 says he does nothing without revealing his secret to his servants the prophets. Leviticus 23 is that revelation written as a calendar. Four lamps have already been lit exactly on schedule. Three are still waiting.

SECTION ELEVEN

Test Everything, Including This

If we are going to ask people to test Sunday, Christmas, Easter, and the claim that Torah was abolished, then we have to hold our own teaching to the same standard. Deuteronomy 4:2 and 12:32 forbid adding to his instructions as clearly as they forbid taking away from them, and adding usually happens by

accident, through a phrase repeated so often that nobody checks it anymore.

Four questions to run everything through, this handout included:

- **Where does Scripture command it?** Chapter and verse, not a teaching you heard.
- **Where does Torah establish it?** The foundation has to carry the weight.
- **Do the Prophets and Writings confirm it?** Two or three witnesses, not one favorite verse.
- **Do the Apostolic writings agree with that foundation?** They never overturn it.

WHERE THIS STUDY DRAWS THE LINE

Three things in this handout are labeled as interpretation rather than commandment, on purpose: the eighth day as the place of the marriage supper, the two loaves as the two houses, and the Wednesday timeline of the execution week. Each one is argued from the text, and each one should be weighed rather than swallowed. And where Scripture stops speaking, we stop calling our interpretation a commandment.

SECTION TWELVE

Walking It Out

None of this is ritual. It is relationship with a schedule attached. Here is how to start, without pretending to be something you are not.

- **Read Leviticus 23 out loud, start to finish, with your family.** It takes about ten minutes. Most believers have never heard the whole chapter read in one sitting.
- **Put the dates on your calendar for the coming year.** You cannot keep an appointment you do not know about.
- **Keep Passover.** Read Exodus 12 at the table. Tell your children what the blood means. That telling is commanded (Exodus 12:26-27; Deuteronomy 6:6-7).
- **Put the leaven out for the week.** Let the physical search prompt the spiritual one.
- **Count the fifty days.** Counting makes you pay attention. It is the only feast that requires it.
- **Rest on Trumpets and listen.** Blow a shofar if you have one. Ask yourself honestly whether you would be ready if that trumpet were the one.
- **Fast and repent on Atonement.** Make the list. Forgive the people on it. Ask forgiveness from the people you have wronged. Do not carry it into another year.
- **Build a booth and rejoice.** Get out of the house, get around other believers, and be altogether joyful. It is commanded, and it is good for a family.

START WHERE YOU ARE

You do not have to keep all seven perfectly this year to begin. Keep the next one that comes. Learn it, teach it to your household, and let him build on it. Obedience is a walk, not a single step, and he is patient with those who are actually walking.

SECTION THIRTEEN

Cross Reference Index

Primary text: Leviticus 23:1-44

Appointed times in creation: Genesis 1:14; Psalm 81:3; Psalm 104:19

The Sabbath as the first moed: Genesis 2:2-3; Exodus 20:8-11; Leviticus 23:3; Isaiah 58:13-14

The lampstand: Exodus 25:31-40; Zechariah 4:2, 6; Revelation 1:12-13, 20

Pilgrimage feasts, the chag: Exodus 23:14-17; Deuteronomy 16:16

Passover: Exodus 12:1-14, 21-27, 39, 46; Numbers 9:12; Psalm 34:20; Isaiah 53:4-9; Matthew 26:17-20; Mark 14:12-17; Luke 22:7-15; John 1:29, 36; John 13:1; John 18:28; John 19:14, 31-36; 1 Corinthians 5:7; 1 Corinthians 11:23; Hebrews 9:22; 1 Peter 1:18-19; Revelation 5:6-9

Unleavened Bread: Exodus 12:15-20; Exodus 13:6-7; Micah 5:2; Psalm 16:10; Matthew 16:6-12; John 6:35, 48-51; Acts 2:27, 31; Acts 13:35-37; 1 Corinthians 5:6-8; 2 Corinthians 5:21; Hebrews 4:15; 1 Peter 2:22

Firstfruits: Leviticus 23:9-16; Matthew 12:40; Matthew 27:52-53; Matthew 28:1-6; Mark 16:2-6; John 19:31; John 20:1, 17; Romans 8:29; 1 Corinthians 15:20-23; Colossians 1:18; James 1:18

Pentecost: Leviticus 23:15-22; Exodus 19:1, 16-20; Exodus 20:1-17; Exodus 31:18; Exodus 32:28; Deuteronomy 16:9-12; Ruth 1:22; Ruth 2:2-3, 23; Jeremiah 31:31-33; Ezekiel 36:26-27; Ezekiel 37:15-22; Joel 2:28-29; Acts 2:1-21, 41; Romans 8:23; 2 Corinthians 3:3; Ephesians 2:11-16

Trumpets: Leviticus 23:23-25; Numbers 10:1-10; Numbers 28:11; Numbers 29:1-6; 1 Samuel 20:5, 18; Psalm 81:3; Psalm 104:19; Isaiah 27:13; Joel 2:1; Zephaniah 1:14-16; Matthew 24:29-31, 36, 42-44; Matthew 25:1-13; 1 Corinthians 15:51-52; 1 Thessalonians 4:16-17; Revelation 11:15

Atonement: Leviticus 16:1-34; Leviticus 23:26-32; Leviticus 25:9-10; Ezra 8:21; Psalm 35:13; Isaiah 53:4-6; Isaiah 58:3-7; Isaiah 61:1-2; Zechariah 12:10; Zechariah 13:1; Luke 4:18-19; Romans 3:24-25; Hebrews 4:14-16; Hebrews 9:6-14, 24-28; Hebrews 10:1-14

Tabernacles and the eighth day: Leviticus 23:33-43; Deuteronomy 16:13-15; Nehemiah 8:14-18; Ezekiel 37:26-27; Zechariah 14:16-19; John 1:14; John 7:2, 37-39; John 8:12; Revelation 7:9-10; Revelation 19:7-9; Revelation 21:1-5

Shadow and fulfillment: Matthew 5:17-18; Luke 22:15-18; Acts 20:6, 16; Colossians 2:16-17; Hebrews 8:5; Hebrews 10:1; Ezekiel 45:17, 21, 25; Isaiah 66:23; Amos 3:7

Adding and taking away: Deuteronomy 4:2; Deuteronomy 12:32; Proverbs 30:5-6; Matthew 15:3-9; Mark 7:7-9

Teaching the household: Exodus 12:26-27; Exodus 13:8-10; Deuteronomy 6:6-9; Psalm 78:4-7

Walk in truth, walk in light. Shalom.